



Introduction: What Is Cybersecurity?

Cybersecurity *protected* computers, phones, and networks from bad people called hackers. Hackers *wanted* to steal information or break
5 systems. Today, we *used* the internet for many things, like work, school, and shopping. So, cybersecurity *became* very important. In this text, we *learned* about the main parts of cybersecurity and *looked* at recent events. We also *practiced*
10 simple past tense and *added* new IT words to your vocabulary.

1. Main Parts of Cybersecurity

Cybersecurity *had* many parts. Each part *helped* to keep systems safe. Here are the most important
15 parts:

1.1. Network Security

A **network** is a group of computers that *talked* to each other. Network security *protected* these

computers from attacks. For example, hackers
20 *tried* to send bad software, called **malware**,
through the network. Companies *used* **firewalls** (a
tool to block bad traffic) and **intrusion**
prevention systems (IPS) to stop hackers. In the
past, network security *focused* on simple attacks,
25 but now it *needed* to stop very smart hackers.

•**New IT Words:** network, malware, firewall,
intrusion prevention system (IPS)

1.2. Endpoint Security

An **endpoint** is a device, like a computer or
30 phone, that *connected* to a network. Endpoint
security *kept* these devices safe. Hackers often
attacked endpoints first. Companies *used*
**endpoint protection platforms* (EPP) to find and
stop malware. For example, if a worker *used* a
35 personal phone for work, the company *needed* to
protect that phone.

- New IT Words:** endpoint, endpoint protection platform (EPP)

1.3. Application Security

40 An **application** is a program, like a game or a website, that people *used*. Application security *stopped* hackers from breaking these programs. Developers *tested* applications to find problems before hackers *found* them. For example, a bank
45 app *needed* strong security so hackers *could not* steal money.

- New IT Words:** application, developer

1.4. Data Security and Privacy

50 **Data** is information, like names, emails, or bank details. Data security *protected* this information. Companies *used* **encryption* (a way to hide data) to keep it safe. Hackers *wanted* to steal data, so companies *followed* **privacy* laws, like the **GDPR** in Europe. For example, if a company *lost*
55 data, it *paid* a big fine.

- New IT Words:** data, encryption, privacy, GDPR

1.5. Identity and Access Management (IAM)

Identity is who you are, like your username.

60 **Access** is what you can do, like open a file. IAM *made* sure only the right people *accessed* systems. Companies *used* **multi-factor authentication* (MFA), which *asked* for a password and a phone code. Hackers *tried* to steal passwords, so IAM
65 *helped* stop them.

- New IT Words:** identity, access, multi-factor authentication (MFA)

1.6. Incident Response and Recovery

An **incident** is a problem, like a hacker attack.

70 Incident response *helped* companies fix problems fast. For example, if hackers *stole* data, the company *followed* a plan to stop them and

recovered the data. Companies *used* **security operations centers* (SOCs) to watch for problems.

- 75 •**New IT Words:** incident, security operations center (SOC), recovery

2. New Changes in Cybersecurity

Cybersecurity *changed* a lot in recent years. Here are some big changes:

80 **2.1. Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Machine Learning (ML)**

Artificial intelligence (AI) and **machine learning** (ML) *helped* find hackers faster. Companies *used* AI to look at data and find
85 strange things. But hackers also *used* AI to make better attacks. For example, hackers *created* fake emails that *looked* very real.

- New IT Words:** artificial intelligence (AI), machine learning (ML)

90 2.2. Zero-Trust Security

Zero-trust security *said*, “Trust no one.” It *checked* everyone, even workers, before they *accessed* systems. Companies *liked* zero-trust because it *stopped* hackers who *pretended* to be
95 workers.

•**New IT Words:** zero-trust

2.3. Ransomware-as-a-Service (RaaS)

Ransomware is malware that *locked* computers and *asked* for money. Hackers *sold* ransomware
100 on the internet, called **ransomware-as-a-service** (RaaS). This *made* it easy for new hackers to attack. For example, the Conti gang *used* RaaS and *attacked* a government in 2022.

•**New IT Words:** ransomware, ransomware-
105 as-a-service (RaaS)

2.4. Supply Chain Attacks

110 A **supply chain** attack *happened* when hackers *attacked* a company through its partners. For example, in 2020, hackers *used* the SolarWinds company to attack many organizations. They *put* malware in SolarWinds' software, and customers *downloaded* it.

•**New IT Words:** supply chain

3. Recent Events in Cybersecurity

115 Here are some real events that *happened*:

3.1. Russian Hackers and the British Ministry (2023)

120 Russian hackers *stole* documents from the British Ministry of Defense. They *used* a partner company to get in. The documents *had* secrets about a nuclear base. This *showed* how dangerous supply chain attacks *were*.

3.2. North Korean Phishing (2023)

North Korean hackers *sent* fake emails, called
125 **phishing**, to cybersecurity companies in the U.S.
They *wanted* to steal secrets. This *proved* that
even security experts *needed* protection.

•New IT Words: phishing

3.3. MOVEit Attack (2023)

130 Hackers *found* a problem in MOVEit, a file
transfer program. They *attacked* thousands of
organizations and *stole* data. This *happened*
because many companies *used* the same software.

4. Conclusion

135 Cybersecurity *protected* our computers and data
from hackers. It *had* many parts, like network
security, endpoint security, and data privacy. New
ideas, like AI and zero-trust, *helped* stop attacks.
But hackers also *got* smarter and *used* things like
140 ransomware and phishing. Recent events, like the
MOVEit attack, *showed* why cybersecurity *was*
so important.

Now, you *learned* new IT words and *practiced*
simple past tense. Keep studying, and you
145 *improved* your English and IT knowledge!